region, we finally succeeded in resolving the problem in Mizo hills. Under the peace accord of 30 June 1986 between the MNF and the Government of India, the new state of Mizoram was carved out of Assam. The Mizos have been reaping the benefits of peace since then. On the other hand, the Manipur imbroglio continues. It has by far the maximum militant outfits in the entire northeast. There are ceasefire or cessation of operations agreements with many of them, but notwithstanding that, there is rampant extortion, illegal taxation, violence, inter-factional clashes and other terrorist activities. Tripura is a typical example of conflict of interest among the tribals and non-tribals. A demographic shift has taken place over the past few decades in favour of plainsmen and the tribal population is below 30 per cent. As of now, the law and order situation is well under control, and the state seems to have turned around. It is, in fact, one of the most peaceful states in the northeast.

In Assam, an agitation was started by the All Assam Students' Union in 1979 against illegal migration of Bangladeshis and outsiders, and the exploitation of oil, mineral resources and tea without adequate benefit accruing to the people of Assam. This peaceful agitation continued for six years and as a result, the Asom Gana Parishad, a political party, was created after the signing of the historic Assam accord on 15 August 1985. On the other hand, an armed movement sprouted on 7 April 1979 as an offshoot of the parent organization, and is known as the United Liberation Front of Assam (ULFA). Subsequently, some other militant groups, representing minorities like Karbis, Bodos and Dimasas, surfaced. There is a sense of deprivation among these ethnic minorities and hence, these people are seeking a greater say in their own development and some form of autonomous structure for their areas. However, today, most of these organizations are bereft of any ideology and have almost become criminal groups that are carrying out acts of terrorism, extortion, kidnapping for ransom and killing of innocents. Terrorism has, in fact, become a sort of industry in this region. The crackdown on northeast terrorist outfits by the Bangladesh government in the last two years has given a terrible